

Grade

2

Piano Exam Pieces 2019 & 2020


ABRSM

Piano Exam Pieces

ABRSM Grade 2

Selected from the
2019 & 2020 syllabus



ABRSM Piano Exams

Here are some key points to help you prepare for your Grade 2 exam. All requirements are valid from 1 January 2019 until 31 December 2020. More detailed information on the syllabus requirements and syllabus overlap details can be found online at www.abrsm.org/piano. In the exam, the requirements can be taken in any order.

Pieces

(3 × 30 marks)

This book contains nine pieces from ABRSM's 2019 & 2020 Grade 2 Piano syllabus. In the exam, you will need to play three pieces, one from each of the three syllabus lists (A, B and C).

You can choose from the pieces in this book and/or the other pieces set for the grade: a full list is on the opposite page. You will need to observe all *da capo* (D.C.) and *dal segno* (D.S.) indications but omit all other repeats (including first-time bars) unless they are very brief (i.e. of a few bars) or unless the syllabus specifies otherwise.

Scales, arpeggios and broken chords

(21 marks)

Learning scales, arpeggios and broken chords helps you to build strong technical skills by developing reliable finger movement, hand position, co-ordination and keyboard fluency. It also helps you to develop your musical understanding through familiarity with keys and their related patterns.

You can find a complete list of scales, arpeggios and broken chords required for Grade 2 in the back of this book. In the exam, they should be played from memory, without pedalling. You are free to start at any octave, provided the required ranges are covered. For all 'hands together' requirements, your hands should be one octave apart.

Sight-reading

(21 marks)

Learning to sight-read helps you to develop quick recognition of keys and tonality, rhythm and common patterns of beats. It also helps you to learn to keep going even when you make mistakes, and work music out for yourself – which makes learning new pieces quicker and easier.

In the exam, you will be asked to play a short piece of music that you have not previously seen. You will be given half a minute in which to look through and, if you wish, try out all or any part of the test before you are asked to play it to the examiner for assessment. For the full sight-reading parameters, please see the syllabus.

Aural tests

(18 marks)

Aural skills enable you to assess the sound and balance of your playing, keep in time and play with a sense of rhythm and pulse. These skills also help you to develop your sense of pitch, your musical memory and to spot any mistakes.

In the exam, the tests will be administered by the examiner from the piano, and you will be asked:

- a To clap the pulse of a piece played by the examiner, and to identify whether it is in two time or three time.
- b To sing as 'echoes' three phrases played by the examiner.
- c To identify a change in either pitch or rhythm during a phrase played by the examiner.
- d To answer questions about two features of a piece played by the examiner.

For more detailed information on the tests, please see the syllabus.

(Total available: 150 marks)

Editorial guidance

We have taken the pieces in this book from a variety of sources. Where appropriate, we have edited the pieces to help you prepare for your performance. We have added metronome markings (in square brackets) and ornament realizations. Details of other changes or suggestions are given in the footnotes. These editorial additions are for guidance only: you do not have to follow them in the exam.

Piano Exam Pieces

ABRSM Grade 2

Selected from the 2019 & 2020 syllabus

Name

Date of exam

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Editor for ABRSM: Richard Jones

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| 5 | Handel Air (Hornpipe) in D minor, HWV 461. <i>Handel: Easy Piano Pieces and Dances</i> (Bärenreiter) | |
| 6 | Haydn Allegro (4th movt from <i>Sonata in G</i> , Hob. XVI:8). <i>Haydn: Selected Keyboard Sonatas, Book 1</i> (ABRSM) | |

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- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| 4 | Beethoven Nel cor più, arr. Fly. <i>With the Immortals</i> (Forsyth) | |
| 5 | Gurlitt Night Journey (No. 65 from <i>The First Steps of the Young Pianist</i> , Op. 82). <i>Music Through Time, Piano Book 1</i> (OUP) | |
| 6 | Somervell Plaintive Waltz (from <i>Holiday Pictures</i>). <i>A Romantic Sketchbook for Piano, Book 1</i> (ABRSM) | |

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- | | | |
|---|--|--|
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| 6 | Pam Wedgwood Lazy Days: No. 7 from <i>Up-Grade! Piano Grades 1-2</i> (Faber) | |

A:1

Lesson in C

No. 10 from *Die ersten 12 Lektionen*, Op. 125

Edited by Howard Ferguson

Anton Diabelli
(1781-1858)

Allegretto [$\text{♩} = c.88$]

The musical score is presented in a grand staff format with two systems of two staves each. The first system (measures 1-4) begins with a piano (*p*) dynamic. The second system (measures 5-8) features a forte (*f*) dynamic. The third system (measures 9-12) returns to piano (*p*). The fourth system (measures 13-16) features a forte (*f*) dynamic. The score includes various musical notations such as treble and bass clefs, time signature, key signature (one sharp), and specific performance instructions like fingerings and dynamics.

The Austrian musician Anton Diabelli settled in Vienna as a music teacher and composer. In 1818 he established a music publishing firm in the city, becoming Schubert's first and chief publisher. In the following year, he sent a waltz theme to all the leading Austrian composers, asking them to write a variation on it. This resulted in one of Beethoven's greatest piano compositions, the so-called Diabelli Variations, Op. 120 (1823).

In the 'Lesson in C', note the contrasting theme in the dominant key at bb. 17-24, which is just as charming as the original theme.

Source: *Die ersten 12 Lektionen*, Op. 125 (Vienna: Diabelli, 1830). Some phrase marks and dynamics have been added by the editor.

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Reproduced from *A Keyboard Anthology*, First Series, Book I, edited by Howard Ferguson (ABRSM)

17

f

legato

21

p

25

mf

29

cresc. *sf* *f*

A:2

Musette in D

BWV Anh. II 126

Anon.

[♩ = c.72]

f

p

Fine

mf

p

mf

D.C. al Fine

This piece, generally thought to be by one of J. S. Bach's sons, is found in a little manuscript keyboard book, called 'Clavierbüchlein' (Little Keyboard Book), that Bach dedicated to his wife Anna Magdalena in 1725. This little anthology gives a fascinating glimpse of the music-making that took place in the Bach family's Leipzig home.

The musette is an 18th-century dance movement in pastoral style, with a drone bass that imitates the small French bagpipe known as a 'musette'. This explains the pedal bass that runs through much of this musette.

Source: Staatsbibliothek zu Berlin, Preussischer Kulturbesitz, Mus. ms. Bach P225. All dynamics, slurs and staccatos are editorial suggestions only.

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Adapted from J. S. Bach et al.: *The Anna Magdalena Bach Book of 1725*, edited by Richard Jones (ABRSM)

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Gigue in the English Style

Gigue à l'Angloise

A:3

Sixth movement from Partita in G, BWV 32:1

G. P. Telemann
(1681-1767)

[♩ = c.88]

5

13

French and Italian forms of the dance type known as gigue were common in Telemann's day, but here he attempts a 'Gigue in the English Style', to quote the title – an imitation of the older English 'jig'.

Georg Philipp Telemann, an immensely prolific German composer, was city music director at Frankfurt (1712–21), then at Hamburg (1721–67). As a composer, he was versatile enough to turn his hand to all the different styles and genres of his day.

Source: *Der getreue Music-Meister* (Hamburg, 1728). All dynamics and slurs are editorial suggestions only.

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Adapted from *Baroque Keyboard Pieces*, Book I, edited by Richard Jones (ABRSM)

B:1

Arabesque

No. 2 from 25 études faciles et progressives, Op. 100

J. F. F. Burgmüller
(1806-74)

Allegro scherzando ♩ = 152

5

p

p leggiero

cresc.

mf

sf

f

5

9

12

5

3

Johann Friedrich Franz Burgmüller, German by birth, settled in Paris after 1832. There he became popular as a pianist and composer, improvising hundreds of salon pieces and composing much piano music for teaching purposes. Many of his short piano pieces have programmatic titles.

An *arabesque* is an ornament found in Arabic art, so in music it refers to decorative writing. In this piece, the arabesque is the quick, short, light semiquaver figure that dominates the right hand of the outer sections (bb. 3 and 19) and the left hand of the middle section (b. 11). Although the composer's metronome mark is ♩ = 152, students may prefer a more relaxed tempo, for example ♩ = 116.

Source: 25 études faciles et progressives, Op. 100 (London: Schott, 1854). The original title is 'L'arabesque'. The dynamic in b. 7 is editorial, as are the directions *sim.* and *stacc.* in bb. 3 and 19.

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Adapted from Burgmüller: 25 Easy and Progressive Studies, Op. 100 (ABRSM)

B:2

Waltz

No. 13 from 24 Easy Pieces, Op. 39

D. B. Kabalevsky
(1904-87)Allegro non troppo [$\text{♩} = c.60$]

1 3 4 2 4 3 2

p

pp $\frac{1}{3}$ *sempre stacc.*

9

cresc. *mf*

17

p *cresc.* *mf*

25

dim. *rit.* *p*

The Russian composer Dmitry Borisovich Kabalevsky studied piano and composition at the Moscow Conservatory, where he later taught, being appointed professor in 1939. He was active in the field of music education and wrote much music for young people, including the 24 Easy Pieces, Op. 39, from which this waltz is selected. Here, the sharp contrast between the two hands – sustained, *cantabile* melody in the right; repeated staccato chords in the left – is maintained throughout.

Source: No. 13 from 24 Little Pieces, Op. 39 (1967)

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Published in 24 Little Pieces, Op. 39 (ISMN 979-0-060-034299)

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Lazy Bear

from *Piano Sketches*, Book 1

B:3

Vitalij Neugasimov
(born 1978)

Grave ♩ = 60

5 4 3 2 1

1. 4 2 1

7b 2. 5 5 4 1

12 5 5 3 5 4

Fine 8va

D.C. al Fine

Neugasimov's *Piano Sketches*, from which this piece is selected, is a short series of piano miniatures that cover a range of musical styles. In this piece, he paints a picture of a lazy bear: the left-hand melody is at very low pitch, particularly in the major-mode middle section (bb. 9–16).

Vitalij Neugasimov was born in Vilnius, capital of Lithuania, in 1978. He studied piano, organ and music education at the Lithuanian Music Academy, graduating in 2004. He is now active as a music teacher, composer, arranger, conductor and accompanist.

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C:1

Dusty Blue

from *Paint Box*

June Armstrong
(born 1951)

Bluesy ♩ = c.76 (♩ = ♩[♮])

molto rit.

This piece is selected from June Armstrong's *Paint Box: Very First Concert Pieces for Piano*, where the pieces are organized by colour. The title 'Dusty Blue' is given to a piece in blues style: this applies not only to the character of its right-hand melody, but also to the twelve-bar blues bass and chords that underpin it in the left hand.

The composer has written: 'Keep the left hand very solid and not too fast. You can finger this 5 1, 5 1, etc. or 5 2, 5 1. Make the final *ritenuto* really slow up at the end to give a very bluesy feel.' No dynamics are given, but she says: 'Choose your own and experiment to find out what works best.'

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Ja-Da

C:2

Arranged by Nikki Iles

Bob Carleton
(c.1894-1956)

Swinging! $\text{♩} = c.116$ ($\text{♩} = \text{♩}^3$)

The musical score for 'Ja-Da' is written for piano in 4/4 time. The key signature has two flats (B-flat major). The tempo is marked 'Swinging!' with a note value of $\text{♩} = c.116$ and a triplet notation $(\text{♩} = \text{♩}^3)$. The score is divided into four systems of six measures each.

- System 1 (Measures 1-6):** Measure 1 starts with a forte (*f*) dynamic. Measure 4 has a mezzo-forte (*mf*) dynamic. Measure 6 ends with a piano (*p*) dynamic and the instruction 'cheekily'.
- System 2 (Measures 7-12):** Measure 9 has a mezzo-piano (*mp*) dynamic with a crescendo (*cresc.*) marking. Measure 11 has a mezzo-forte (*mf*) dynamic.
- System 3 (Measures 13-18):** Measure 13 has a forte (*f*) dynamic. Measure 15 has a forte (*f*) dynamic. Measure 18 ends with a forte (*f*) dynamic.

The score includes various musical notations such as slurs, ties, and fingerings (e.g., 1, 2, 3, 4, 5) to guide the performer.

Bob Carleton was an American jazz pianist and composer who wrote over 500 songs, including the 1918 hit 'Ja-Da'. This song became a jazz standard and was performed by many artists and bands, including The Original New Orleans Jazz Band, Frank Sinatra and Oscar Peterson.

'Ja-Da' featured in the Tom and Jerry cartoon Trap Happy (1946), where it was heard when Butch the exterminator cat arrives to rid the house of Jerry the mouse. Naturally, he fails!

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Reproduced from *Piano Mix 1*, compiled and edited by David Blackwell (ABRSM)

C:3

Petite valse

from *Lazy Days*

Brian Chapple
(born 1945)

Andante [$\text{♩} = c.50$]

mp dolce, leggiero

poco cresc.

dim.

mp

rall.

dim.

'Petite valse' is French for 'little waltz'. The *cantabile* melody in triple time, accompanied by repeated chords on the second and third beats, is characteristic of this type of dance.

The English composer Brian Chapple studied composition with Lennox Berkeley and piano with Harry Isaacs at the Royal Academy of Music, London. He has written a wide variety of music, including three small books of piano pieces for his pupils: *In the Pink*, *On the Cool Side*, and *Lazy Days* from which this piece is selected.

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Scales, arpeggios and broken chords

You will be asked for at least one of each type of scale, arpeggio and broken chord, which should be played legato and from memory.

	RANGE	REQUIREMENTS
SCALES (SIMILAR MOTION)		
G, D, A, F majors	2 oct.	hands together <i>or</i> separately, as chosen by the examiner
E, D, G minors (natural <i>or</i> harmonic <i>or</i> melodic, at candidate's choice)		
CONTRARY-MOTION SCALES		
C, E majors	2 oct.	hands beginning on the tonic (unison)
CHROMATIC SCALE		
beginning on D	1 oct.	hands separately
ARPEGGIOS		
G, D, A majors	2 oct.	hands separately
D, G minors		
BROKEN CHORDS		
F major	2 oct.	hands separately, as pattern below:
E minor		

